SCCD-X v2.00 · PROSE READING · THE 2027 FORECAST

Cambodia (KH)

No loop running, and the shortest fuse but one

Run 2026-10-09 · horizon to end-2027 · LSODA

The figures this reading rests on

Band	Tier	Mode	Ψ 2027	θ₂₅	Δ_norm	R_B
Equilibrium	Coherent	MIXED	0.749	0.999	+0.046	0

Loops none · Nearest gate s3 ~8y · At 15 years Crisis / Incoherent

Cambodia reads Equilibrium / Coherent through 2027 with no active loop at all — and yet its $\hat{S}_3$ gate is eight years out, the second-shortest in the region, and the fifteen-year reading is Crisis / Incoherent. It is the largest gap in the set between how settled a polity looks now and where its drifts point.

The absence of loops is genuine, not an oversight. L1 does not arm because the coercive monopoly is intact; L3 does not arm because fragmentation is 0.22, among the lowest here — the opposition was dismantled, so there is little left to fragment; L6 does not arm because haven reallocation at 0.42 sits below the 0.55 trigger despite an extraction squeeze of +0.202. A polity can be in poor structural condition and still show no running feedback, and Cambodia is the clearest example in the region.

What the engine does register is capital concentration. $\hat{C}_1$ is 0.63 with a crony coding of 0.90, the highest in the set, and V-Dem's political-corruption index at 0.904 is the second worst of the eleven. The oknha system ties licence to patronage directly. Chinn-Ito puts capital-account openness at 1.00 — fully open de jure, so capital controls are zero — in a dollarised economy. Concentrated capital with an unobstructed exit is a configuration the engine watches, and it is why L4's capital threshold is one of the two parameters that flips this verdict.

The conflict coding of 0.22 is non-zero for a reason a state-based conflict series would miss. The scam compounds are armed, extraterritorial and — on the Prime Minister's own February 2026 account — destroying the legal economy; a US Institute of Peace estimate put the revenue at over $12.5bn a year, which he disputed. A seven-month campaign reported 5,106 arrests and 4,534 deportations. Whatever the true figure, an armed parallel economy operating inside the territory is a rival to the coercive monopoly, and that is what $\hat{S}_2$ measures.

External pressure is coded at 0.58, the second-highest here after Myanmar, and it is the Thai border: two rounds of fighting in 2025, a 27 December ceasefire that Stratfor rated as holding but not normalising in August 2026, and Thai forces on ground Phnom Penh calls occupied.

The stress branch

Cambodia produces the one genuinely counter-intuitive result in the whole run: under the stress branch Ψ RISES, from 0.749 to 0.842. The cause is the event catalogue's coding of interstate_war_onset, which raises $\hat{S}_2$ and $\hat{S}_3$ — the rally effect sccd Part V documents for 1941–45. A border escalation, on the engine's own logic, consolidates a patrimonial state in the short run. That is the engine's reading and not mine, and it is exactly the kind of result worth leaving visible rather than smoothing away.

What would have to be wrong

Two parameters flip the verdict. The input weakness is sharper than the parameter weakness here: Cambodia has no WDI Gini observation in the 2012–2026 window, so the capital-concentration term uses an argued 30.5 that is almost certainly a floor — consumption Ginis badly understate concentration where the top of the distribution is informal.

What to watch in 2027

— The $\hat{S}_3$ path. Eight years to the 0.30 floor is the second-shortest fuse in the region and nothing in the 2027 reading reflects it yet.

— Scam-economy enforcement, and specifically whether it reaches the patronage layer or stays at the arrest-and-deport level.

— Border normalisation versus the current frozen state. The engine says escalation helps in the short run; it says nothing kind about the medium.

— Any sign of capital leaving. Openness is 1.00 and concentration is high; there is no friction in the way.

What the engine does not say

Coherent here means the state can act consistently, which in a patrimonial system includes acting consistently in its own interest. The tier is not a performance rating.

This is INTERPRETATION, not engine output. The engine emits a band, a tier, a mode, a loop set and a gate order; it does not emit an argument about what they mean. The companion technical report (SCCDX-2027-KH-en.pdf) carries the numbers and provenance tags this reading stands on.